



NO ONE IS COMING

A Project Zomboid Build 42 Modlist & Survival Guide

Build 42.12.3 | 3 Waves | For New & Veteran Survivors

Best viewed digitally. Print at your own toner expense.

Compiled July 2026

Table of Contents

Preface	7
How This Guide Works	7
[B42] Mod Manager	7
Installation	7
Profiles	7
Adding Mods to a Profile	8
Load Order	8
Saving and Launching	8
Switching Waves	8
A Note on Difficulty	9
Installation & Troubleshooting	10
Before You Begin	10
Installing Mods	10
Step 1: Subscribe on Steam Workshop	10
Step 2: Enable in Mod Manager	10
Step 3: Arrange Load Order	10
Step 4: Start a New Game	10
Wave-Specific Load Order	11
Wave 0 (5 mods)	11
Wave 1 (20-40 mods)	11
Wave 2 (40+ mods)	11
Troubleshooting	11
Game Won't Start (Black Screen / CTD)	11
Red Error Box	11
Mods Not Showing in Game	11
Save Corrupted	11
Still Stuck?	12
Background — The First Night	14
Sandbox Settings — Wave 0	15
Game World	15
Population	15
Zombie Lore	15
Loot	15
Character	16
World	16
Nature	16
Starting Location	16
Beginner Trait Build	17
How to Play — Wave 0	18
1. Getting Started	18
2. Basic Controls	18
Movement & Combat	18
Inventory & Interaction	18
3. Combat — Read This First	19
Weapons	19
When to Run	19
4. The UI	19
5. Character Creation	20

Occupation	20
Positive Traits (pick a few you can afford)	20
Negative Traits (fund your positives)	20
6. Basic Needs	20
Water	20
Food	20
Sleep	21
Shelter	21
7. First Day Checklist	21
8. TV and Radio	21
Life and Living TV	21
Radios	21
9. Moodles	21
10. Death and What Comes After	22
What to Do If Bitten	22
11. First Night Strategy	22
12. Days 2-7 — What's Next	22
Modlist — Wave 0	23
Mod Manager	23
UI & Quality of Life	23
Background — Scars and Lessons	26
Sandbox Settings — Wave 1	27
Game World	27
Population	27
Zombie Lore	27
Loot	27
Character	27
World	28
Nature	28
Starting Location	28
Intermediate Trait Build	28
Strategy Guide — Wave 1	29
1. Base Building & Fortification	29
Choosing a Base	29
Carpentry Milestones	29
Key Base Features	29
2. Farming	29
Getting Started	29
Crop Selection	30
Disease	30
3. Trapping & Fishing	30
Trapping	30
Fishing	30
4. Vehicles & Mechanics	30
Finding and Starting a Car	30
Vehicle Condition	30
Leveling Mechanics	31
5. Generators & Electrical	31
6. Metalworking	31

7. Medical System	31
Injury Types	31
Supplies to Carry	32
8. Tailoring & Armor	32
9. Long-Term Survival Planning	32
Pre-Shutoff Checklist	32
Winter Survival	32
The Long Game	33
Modlist – Wave 1	34
Mod Manager	34
Framework	34
Items & Equipment	34
UI & Quality of Life	36
Graphics	38
Vehicles	39
Professions & Traits	40
Content & Locations	41
Better Sorting – Status Update	42
Load Order	42
Background – No One is Coming	44
Sandbox Settings – Wave 2	45
Game World	45
Population	45
Zombie Lore	45
Loot	45
Character	45
World	46
Nature	46
Starting Conditions	46
Starting Location	46
Hardcore Trait Build	46
Expert Guide – Wave 2	47
1. The Winter Start	47
Day 1 Priorities (in this order)	47
2. Sprinters	47
Rules	47
Identifying Sprinters	47
3. Hardcore Survival Systems	47
Nutrition Management	47
Temperature & Hypothermia	48
Hygiene	48
Mental Health	48
Thirst	48
4. Advanced Combat	48
Horde Clearing Methods	48
5. Community Server Setup	48
Self-Hosted	48
Dedicated Server	48
6. Endgame Meta	49

Sustainability Checklist	49
Infinite Resources	49
Your Goal	49
Modlist – Wave 2	50
Mod Manager	50
Frameworks & Libraries	50
Survival Overhauls	51
Zombie Overhauls	53
Realism Systems	54
Professions & Traits	56
Crafting Expansions	57
Maps & Locations	58
Immersion & Atmosphere	59
Summary	61
Load Order	62

Preface

Welcome to **No One is Coming**, a wave-based modlist and survival guide for Project Zomboid Build 42. Whether you're loading into Knox County for the first time or you've survived a thousand winters, this guide walks you through curated experiences — each one a complete new game with its own story, settings, and mod list.

How This Guide Works

This guide is organized into three **Waves**. Each wave is a self-contained game setup:

- **Wave 0 — The First Night:** A gentle introduction. Complete beginner? Start here. Minimal mods, easy settings, thorough tutorial.
- **Wave 1 — Scars and Lessons:** You've survived. Now thrive. More mods, harder settings, strategy-focused.
- **Wave 2 — No One is Coming:** The real apocalypse. Maximum mods, brutal settings, advanced systems.

Each wave assumes knowledge from previous waves. Start at Wave 0 even if you've played before.

[B42] Mod Manager

All waves use the **[B42] Mod Manager** as the foundation for managing mods.

[B42] Mod Manager

Steam Workshop

Category: UI / QoL

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Dedicated in-game mod management UI. Replaces the vanilla Mods screen with profiles, drag-and-drop load order, and conflict detection.

Essential tool for managing mods in Build 42. Create mod profiles (one per wave), reorder mods, save/load configurations, and detect known conflicts.

Installation

- Subscribe to **[B42] Mod Manager** on Steam Workshop using the link above.
- Launch Project Zomboid. On the main menu, click **Mods** in the bottom-left.
- Find **[B42] Mod Manager** in the list and click the toggle to enable it. A popup may appear — click **Enable**.
- Exit the Mods screen and return to the main menu. You should now see a new **Mod Manager** button on the left side. Click it.

Profiles

Profiles let you save and switch between different mod configurations. Each wave in this guide should have its own profile:

- Inside the Mod Manager, click **New Profile**.
- Name it after the wave (e.g., “Wave 0 — The First Night”).
- The profile starts empty. You'll add mods to it in the next step.
- Create additional profiles for each wave you plan to play.

TIP:

Profiles are stored in your Zomboid user folder and persist across game sessions. You can switch between them at any time by selecting a different profile in the Mod Manager.

Adding Mods to a Profile

- In the Mod Manager, select the profile you want to configure.
- The left panel lists **Available Mods** — everything you've subscribed to on Steam Workshop.
- Find a mod and click the green arrow to move it to the **Enabled Mods** panel on the right.
- You can also double-click a mod name to toggle it.
- Add every mod listed in your wave's Modlist chapter, in the order specified.
- If a mod shows a red warning icon, it means a dependency is missing — check the mod's Workshop page for requirements.

Load Order

Load order determines which mod takes priority when multiple mods change the same thing. The Mod Manager lets you drag and drop mods to reorder them:

- Click and hold a mod in the **Enabled Mods** panel.
- Drag it up or down to change its position in the load order.
- Mods at the **bottom** of the list load **last** and override mods above them.
- Each wave's Modlist chapter includes a recommended load order. Follow it carefully.
- As a rule: frameworks first, content next, graphics after, UI/QoL last, overrides at the very bottom.

DANGER:

Incorrect load order is the most common cause of mod conflicts and crashes. If your game won't start or mods aren't working, check the load order first. See the Installation chapter for detailed load order rules.

Saving and Launching

- After adding all mods and arranging load order, click **Save Profile** at the bottom.
- Click **Apply and Return to Main Menu**.
- Back on the main menu, click **Solo** or **Host** as normal.
- Your enabled mods are now active. Start a new game with the sandbox settings from your wave's Settings chapter.

WARNING:

Always launch your game **after** configuring the Mod Manager, not through the vanilla Mods screen. If you use the vanilla Mods screen after setting up the Mod Manager, the vanilla screen may overwrite your load order. Stick to the Mod Manager exclusively once you've set it up.

Switching Waves

When you're ready to move to the next wave:

- Return to the main menu and open the Mod Manager.

- Select your new wave's profile from the dropdown (e.g., "Wave 1 — Scars and Lessons").
- Subscribe to all mods listed in the new wave's Modlist chapter if you haven't already.
- Add them to the profile and arrange load order.
- Save and launch a **new game** — do not continue an old save with new mods.

INFO:

You can have all three profiles configured simultaneously. The Mod Manager tracks which mods belong to each profile independently. Switching between waves is just a profile selection away.

A Note on Difficulty

Project Zomboid is a game about dying. You **will** die — probably a lot. That's the point. Each death teaches you something. The question isn't whether you'll survive, but how long you'll last and what story you'll leave behind.

This is how you died.

Installation & Troubleshooting

Before You Begin

WARNING:

Mods can break your game. Back up saves before adding mods. Saves are at: C:\Users\<YourName>\Zomboid\Saves

INFO:

All mods in this guide are verified for Build 42.12.3. If you encounter issues, check Troubleshooting below.

Installing Mods

Step 1: Subscribe on Steam Workshop

Each mod entry includes a clickable Steam Workshop link. Click it, then click the green **Subscribe** button. Steam downloads the mod automatically.

Step 2: Enable in Mod Manager

- Launch Project Zomboid.
- Click **Mod Manager** on the main menu.
- Select your wave profile (or create one).
- Move mods from **Available** to **Enabled**.

Step 3: Arrange Load Order

- **Libraries and frameworks first** — modding APIs, script extenders, UI libraries.
- **Core overhauls** — major gameplay changes, profession systems.
- **Content mods** — items, weapons, vehicles, clothing.
- **Map mods** — new locations, map expansions.
- **Graphics and visual mods** — textures, models, animations.
- **UI mods** — interface improvements, panels, tooltips.
- **QoL mods** — minor tweaks and convenience features.
- **Compatibility patches** — mods that fix conflicts between other mods.
- **Overrides and tweaks** — mods that change specific behaviors (load last).

DANGER:

Incorrect load order is the 1 cause of mod conflicts and crashes.

Step 4: Start a New Game

WARNING:

Most mods require a **new game**. Do not add mods mid-save unless the mod explicitly says save-compatible. Each wave is designed as a fresh start.

Wave-Specific Load Order

Wave 0 (5 mods)

1. [B42] Mod Manager
- 2-5. UI/QoL mods (order flexible)

Wave 1 (20-40 mods)

1. [B42] Mod Manager
2. UI libraries/frameworks
3. Content mods (items, weapons, vehicles)
4. Graphics mods
5. UI/QoL mods

Wave 2 (40+ mods)

1. [B42] Mod Manager
2. Modding frameworks and libraries
3. Major gameplay overhauls
4. Profession and trait mods
5. Content mods
6. Map mods (base maps first, then additions)
7. Graphics mods
8. UI/QoL mods
9. Compatibility patches
10. Override/tweak mods (load last)

Troubleshooting

Game Won't Start (Black Screen / CTD)

- Check for missing dependencies — Mod Manager shows red warnings.
- Verify load order. Move UI/QoL mods lower.
- Disable mods one by one to find the culprit.
- Verify game cache via Steam: Right-click PZ > Properties > Installed Files > Verify.

Red Error Box

A red error box means Lua errors. Usually:

- The mod is not B42 compatible.
- A dependency is missing or loading after the mod.
- Two mods are conflicting.

Mods Not Showing in Game

- Did you start a **new game**?
- Is the mod enabled in **Mod Manager** (not just the vanilla Mods screen)?
- Some mods require enabling in Sandbox settings — check the mod's Workshop page.

Save Corrupted

DANGER:

Adding/removing mods from an existing save can corrupt it beyond repair. Always start a new game for a new wave. Back up saves before any mod changes.

Still Stuck?

Check the mod's Steam Workshop comments, search [r/projectzomboid](#), or the official PZ Discord.

Wave 0

The First Night

You were just an ordinary person. Maybe you worked in an office, maybe you were a student burning the midnight oil, maybe you were a parent putting the kids to bed. When the screams started outside your window, you had nothing — no gun under the pillow, no bunker in the backyard, no plan. Just the clothes on your back and whatever was in the fridge. The power flickered. The phone lines went dead. The TV played the emergency broadcast on loop until it didn't. You don't know what's happening. You don't know if anyone is coming. You just know you have to make it through the night.

Begin Wave 0

Background — The First Night

You were just an ordinary person. Maybe you worked in an office, staring at spreadsheets and counting down to Friday. Maybe you were a student, pulling all-nighters for exams that suddenly don't matter anymore. Maybe you were a parent, tucking your kids into bed and promising to check for monsters in the closet. You never imagined the monsters would come through the front door.

When the screams started outside your window, you had nothing. No gun under the pillow. No bunker in the backyard. No plan. Just the clothes on your back, whatever was in the fridge, and the sinking realization that the world had changed and nobody had sent you a memo.

The power flickered twice and died. The phone lines went dead an hour later. The TV played the emergency broadcast on a loop — **“Stay indoors. Lock all doors and windows. Do not approach anyone exhibiting symptoms.”** — until the station cut out for good. Now there's only static and the distant sound of breaking glass.

You don't know what's happening. You don't know if the military is coming, if there's a safe zone, if this is happening everywhere or just here. You don't know anything except that the things outside your window used to be your neighbors and now they're pressing their faces against the glass with dead, hungry eyes.

This is your first night. Make it count.

Sandbox Settings — Wave 0

Wave 0 is for complete beginners. Settings give you room to learn without punishing every mistake. Start here, learn the basics, then move on.

Game World

Start a Sandbox game. Select **Survivor** preset, then enter **Custom Sandbox** for these overrides:

Population

Zombie Count	Low (0.5x)
Distribution	Urban Focused
Start Multiplier	0.35
Peak Multiplier	0.65
Peak Day	28

Zombie Lore

Speed	Shamblers
Strength	Weak
Toughness	Fragile
Transmission	Saliva Only (bites)
Infection Mortality	Instant
Cognition	Basic Navigation
Memory	Short
Sight	Normal
Hearing	Normal
Environmental Attacks	Off
Drag Down	Off

Loot

All Categories	Common
Ranged Weapons	Common
Ammunition	Common
Literature	Common
Fresh Food	Normal

Canned Food	Common
Medical	Common
Survival Essentials	Common
Mechanics	Common

Character

XP Multiplier	2.0x
Multihit	Enabled
Rear Vulnerability	Low
Starter Kit	Enabled
Clothing Degradation	Slow

World

Water Shutoff	14-30 days
Electricity Shutoff	14-30 days
House Alarms	Rare
Locked Houses	Rare
Helicopter Events	Once
Meta Events	Rare
Sleeping Event	Never

Nature

Farming Abundance	High
Nature Abundance	High
Fishing Abundance	High
Foraging Abundance	High
Trapping Abundance	High

Starting Location

Rosewood or **Riverside**. Lower zombie count and good starter loot. Avoid West Point and Louisville.

Beginner Trait Build

If character creation is overwhelming, try this:

Occupation: Unemployed (8 free points)

Positives: Cats Eyes (2), Dexterous (2), Outdoorsman (2), Wakeful (2)

Negatives: Weak Stomach (+3), Prone to Illness (+4), Slow Healer (+6), Smoker (+4)

TIP:

Smoker is nearly free points — cigarettes are very common. Just don't forget to smoke when anxious.

WARNING:

Avoid: Deaf, Illiterate, Obese, Very Underweight, Asthmatic, anything below 3 Fitness/Strength. These will kill you quickly as a beginner.

How to Play — Wave 0

Welcome to Knox County. This chapter walks you through everything you need to know as a new player. Take it one section at a time.

1. Getting Started

Project Zomboid is on Steam. For Wave 0, you only need the base game and the 5 mods in the Wave 0 Modlist chapter. Subscribe to them on the Steam Workshop, enable in [B42] Mod Manager, create a “Wave 0” profile. Launch from Mod Manager, click **Solo**, then **Custom Sandbox**, and apply settings from the Sandbox Settings page.

2. Basic Controls

Movement & Combat

WASD	Move
Left Click	Attack / Push
Right Click	Aim weapon
Space	Push / Stomp downed zombie
Ctrl	Crouch (quieter movement)
E	Climb fence / Open window
Shift	Jog (makes noise)
Alt	Sprint (very noisy — last resort)

Inventory & Interaction

I	Inventory
F	Flashlight / Use item
R	Reload weapon
Tab	Health panel
M	Minimap
B	Crafting menu
V	Search/Foraging mode

DANGER:

The **Q** key shouts. It attracts zombies from a huge radius. Do not press Q by accident. Unbind it if needed.

3. Combat — Read This First

Project Zomboid combat is not forgiving. Here's the minimum you need before your first fight:

- **Right-click to aim.** Your character faces the cursor. You cannot attack without aiming.
- **Left-click to attack.** Weapon in hand = swing. Empty hand = push.
- **Spacebar to push/stomp.** Push zombies away when they get close. Stomp a downed zombie's head.
- **Backpedal while fighting.** Walk backwards (S) while aiming. Never stand still.
- **Fight one at a time.** If 3+ zombies approach, walk away and find a safer position.
- **Check behind you.** Zombies come from off-screen. Turn around often.
- **Rest between fights.** If you see the Exhausted moodle (top-right), retreat and sit down to rest.

TIP:

Practice on a single zombie: find one alone, approach slowly, aim, push it down, stomp its head. Do this a few times. Now you know the basics.

Weapons

Better weapons are found in garages, sheds, and hardware stores. Initially, anything is better than bare hands:

- **Frying pan, rolling pin, kitchen knife** — found in house kitchens. Use until you find better.
- **Hammer, pipe, wrench** — found in garages and sheds. Short range but common.
- **Baseball bat, crowbar, axe** — best weapons. Found in garages, hardware stores, and warehouses.

TIP:

The **crowbar** is excellent for beginners — very durable. If you find one, keep it.

When to Run

Walk away if: there are 3+ zombies, you're tired, you're panicked, or you hear a helicopter. You can always come back.

4. The UI

Key parts of the screen:

- **Inventory window (I):** What you're carrying. Left side = you, right side = container you're looting.
- **Health panel (Tab):** Injuries, bandages, overall condition.
- **Crafting panel (B):** Available recipes. Grayed out = missing materials or skill.
- **Moodles (top-right):** Icons showing your physical/mental state. Hover over any moodle to see what it means.
- **Hotbar (bottom):** Drag items here for number-key quick access. Put your weapon and water bottle here.

5. Character Creation

Occupation

Your job determines starting skills. For a first playthrough, **Unemployed** gives the most flexibility (8 free trait points). Other friendly options:

- **Carpenter:** +3 Carpentry. Helps with building and barricading.
- **Burger Flipper:** +2 Cooking, +1 Maintenance. Cooking helps with food.
- **Nurse:** +2 First Aid, +1 Lightfooted. Medical skills and quieter movement.

Positive Traits (pick a few you can afford)

- **Cats Eyes (2pts):** See better at night.
- **Dexterous (2pts):** Transfer items faster — saves real time.
- **Outdoorsman (2pts):** Less likely to get sick from weather.
- **Wakeful (2pts):** Need less sleep. More looting time.
- **Brave (4pts):** Less panic in combat. Big difference.
- **Lucky (4pts):** Find better loot.
- **Thick Skinned (6pts):** Better defense against scratches and bites.

Negative Traits (fund your positives)

- **Weak Stomach (+3):** Don't eat rotten food. A good habit anyway.
- **Smoker (+4):** Need cigarettes. They're common. Manageable.
- **Slow Healer (+6):** Injuries heal slower. Stay safe and it won't matter.
- **High Thirst (+6):** Carry two water bottles instead of one.
- **Slow Reader (+2):** Books take longer. Annoying but not dangerous.

WARNING:

Do NOT take: Deaf, Illiterate, Obese, Very Underweight, Asthmatic. These make survival much harder.

6. Basic Needs

Your character needs four things (in order of urgency): safety, water, food, sleep.

Water

Find water sources immediately:

- **Sinks, toilets, bathtubs** — every house. Right-click > Drink.
- **Water bottles** — kitchens. Fill at sinks and carry with you.
- **Water dispensers** — offices and schools. Big water jugs.

INFO:

Water shuts off after 14-30 days. After that, plumbing runs dry. Eventually you'll need rain collectors (Carpentry 4). But that's a Wave 1 concern.

Food

Every house kitchen has:

- **Fridge:** Fresh food. Eat this first — it rots.
- **Cabinets:** Canned food. Save this for later — it never rots.

- **Countertops:** Snacks, chips, soda.

WARNING:

Don't eat **Rotten** food. The **Stale** tag is okay — just less nutritious.

Sleep

Find a bed in any house. Right-click > Sleep. Close curtains and lock doors before sleeping. An unsecured door while you sleep is how you die.

Shelter

Your first priority on day one: find a two-story house on the edge of town. Close all curtains. Lock all doors. Turn off lights. If you have a hammer, nails, and a plank, barricade a ground-floor window (right-click window > Barricade).

7. First Day Checklist

Follow this order on day one:

- Find a weapon — anything from the kitchen or garage.
- Drink from a sink. Fill a water bottle if you find one.
- Find a safe house — two-story, edge of town. Close curtains, lock doors.
- Eat fresh food from the fridge.
- Find a bag — backpack, duffel, anything that increases carry capacity.
- Find a better weapon — check garages and sheds for axes, bats, crowbars.
- If you have a TV, check the **Life and Living** channel at 6:00, 12:00, and 18:00 for free skill XP.
- Before nightfall: close all curtains, lock all doors, turn off lights, go upstairs, be quiet.

8. TV and Radio

Life and Living TV

At 6:00 AM, 12:00 PM, and 6:00 PM, the channel **Life and Living** runs skill shows:

- **6:00 AM — Cooking Show**
- **12:00 PM — Woodcraft (Carpentry)**
- **6:00 PM — Exposure Survival (Fishing, Trapping, Foraging)**

These shows stop after about 9 days — the broadcast eventually goes dead. Watch them while you can.

TIP:

If you find a skill book for the matching skill, read it **before** watching. The XP bonus applies to TV XP too.

Radios

Radios can be tuned to the **Automated Emergency Broadcast** for weather forecasts and helicopter warnings. The frequency is random — check radios you find for the right channel. Keep a radio at your base.

9. Moodles

Moodles are the icons top-right. Hover over any to see details.

Physical (Red): Bleeding (bandage now), Injured, Heavy Load (drop items), Exhausted (rest).

Sickness (Green): Queasy/Nauseous (could be infection), Wet (dry off or get sick), Cold (find warm clothes). **Mental (Blue):** Panic (fades as you kill zombies), Anxious/Stressed (Smoker = need cigarette), Bored (read or go outside). **Comfort (Yellow):** Hungry (eat), Thirsty (drink), Tired (sleep), Pain (take painkillers).

If you were recently injured and see green moodles progressing (queasy -> nauseous -> sick -> fever), it's probably the Knox Infection. There is no cure. Prepare your next character.

10. Death and What Comes After

You will die. It's how the game works.

When you die, you get two choices:

1. **New Character** — Create a new character in the same world. Your old base, items, and crops are still there.
2. **Quit to Menu** — Start fresh. No shame in this as a beginner.

What to Do If Bitten

A zombie bite is always fatal (makes a distinctive sound, health panel shows "Bitten"):

- Accept it. No cure.
- Put your best items in a container at your base for your next character.
- Go out fighting — clear zombies for your next life.

11. First Night Strategy

When the sun sets:

- Close all curtains on every window.
- Lock all exterior doors.
- Turn off all lights — they attract zombies.
- Go upstairs — zombies on the ground floor can't reach you immediately.
- Be quiet — don't run, don't use noisy tools.
- Eat, drink, read a skill book if you have one.
- Sleep. Your character will wake up if zombies break in.

If you hear banging downstairs: stay upstairs, have a spare sheet + nail ready to craft a sheet rope for a window escape.

12. Days 2-7 — What's Next

You made it through the first night. Here's the plan for the first week:

- **Scout your neighborhood.** Get a feel for where things are.
- **Watch Life and Living** at 6:00, 12:00, and 18:00 every day.
- **Find skill books.** Bookstores and schools. Read before practicing skills.
- **Barricade your base.** Board up ground-floor windows.
- **Collect water.** Fill pots, buckets, and bottles before the water shuts off.
- **Find a car.** Check driveways and parking lots. Keys in glove boxes, on the ground, or on zombies nearby.
- **Practice skills.** Disassemble furniture for Carpentry XP, cook meals for Cooking XP, read books.

When you're comfortable with all of this, you're ready for Wave 1.

Modlist — Wave 0

Wave 0 keeps mods to a strict minimum: the Mod Manager plus a handful of UI improvements. Zero gameplay changes.

Mod Manager

[B42] Mod Manager

Steam Workshop

Category: UI / QoL

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds a dedicated mod management interface with profiles, drag-and-drop load order, and conflict detection.

Mandatory for all waves. Create a 'Wave 0' profile before enabling any other mods.

UI & Quality of Life

Mini Health Panel

Steam Workshop

Category: UI

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds a compact, always-visible health panel overlay. Includes muscle strain indicator for B42. No gameplay changes.

Shows a small health panel so you can see injuries at a glance without opening the full health screen. Also shows muscle strain for B42.

Weapon Condition Indicator

Steam Workshop

Category: UI / QoL

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Displays weapon durability and ammo count on hotbar icons. Shows condition bar and alerts on durability loss. No gameplay impact.

Shows a condition bar on each weapon's hotbar icon so you know when it's about to break. Also displays ammo count and flashlight battery.

Has Been Read

Steam Workshop

Category: UI / QoL

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Shows unread marks on books, magazines, and VHS tapes. Complements vanilla B42 checkmark system with faster visual recognition. No gameplay impact.

Marks skill books, magazines, recipes, and VHS tapes you haven't read yet. B42 vanilla already shows checkmarks on read books — this mod shows what you should read next.

INFO:

Note: Better Sorting (3.4M subscribers) was evaluated but excluded. The original is B41-only (last updated 2023). A B42 compatibility patch exists but depends on an abandoned fork and the patch author has suspended support. We will revisit inventory sorting in Wave 1 when a stable B42-native option emerges.

Wave 0 uses exactly 4 mods. All are UI or QoL. You are playing vanilla Project Zomboid with a better interface.

Load order: Mod Manager first, then UI/QoL mods in any order.

Wave 1

Scars and Lessons

You saw it coming. Not in time to save them, but in time to know the signs — the quarantines, the curfews, the way the news stopped showing footage from the exclusion zone. You were a mechanic. A carpenter. A nurse. Someone who knew how things worked and how to fix them. You fortified the house. You stockpiled what you could. It wasn't enough. They came through the west window. You don't talk about what happened next. Now you're alone, moving through a broken world with calloused hands and a hollow chest. You know how to survive — but survival and living are not the same thing. Not anymore.

Begin Wave 1

Background — Scars and Lessons

You saw it coming. Not in time to save them, but in time to know the signs.

When the first reports came out of Louisville — “riots,” they called them — you were already watching. You’d been a mechanic for fifteen years, fixing cars in a shop off the highway, and you’d learned to spot the things people don’t want to see. The quarantines that kept expanding. The curfews nobody explained. The way the news anchors’ smiles got tighter every night until the smiles stopped altogether.

You got the supplies. You boarded the windows. You told yourself the same thing everyone tells themselves: **it won’t reach us here.**

It reached you.

They came through the west window at two in the morning. You don’t talk about what happened next. You don’t talk about the blood on the kitchen floor or the sound the door made when something kept throwing itself against it. You don’t talk about the fact that you were the only one who made it out.

Now you’re alone. You move through a broken world with calloused hands and a hollow chest. You know how to fix an engine, how to wire a generator, how to build a wall that’ll hold. You know how to survive. But somewhere along the line, you forgot how to do anything else.

Survival and living are not the same thing. Not anymore.

Sandbox Settings — Wave 1

Wave 1 is standard Apocalypse difficulty. Challenging but fair. You should have completed Wave 0 first.

Game World

Start a Sandbox game. Select **Apocalypse** preset, then apply overrides:

Population

Zombie Count	Normal (1.0x)
Start Multiplier	0.65
Peak Multiplier	1.5
Peak Day	28

Zombie Lore

Speed	Fast Shamblers
Strength	Normal
Toughness	Normal
Transmission	Saliva Only
Cognition	Normal
Memory	Normal
Sight	Normal
Hearing	Normal
Environmental Attacks	On

Loot

All Categories	Rare
----------------	------

Character

XP Multiplier	1.0x
Multihit	Disabled
Rear Vulnerability	Normal
Starter Kit	Disabled

World

Water Shutoff	0-14 days
Electricity Shutoff	0-14 days
House Alarms	Sometimes
Helicopter Events	Sometimes
Meta Events	Sometimes

Nature

All Abundances	Normal
-----------------------	--------

Starting Location

Muldraugh or **Rosewood**. Muldraugh has a warehouse and main strip but higher zombie density.

Intermediate Trait Build

Occupation: Carpenter (+3 Carpentry, +1 Short Blunt)

Positives: Brave (4), Dexterous (2), Outdoorsman (2), Cats Eyes (2)

Negatives: Smoker (+4), Weak Stomach (+3), Slow Healer (+6), High Thirst (+6)

TIP:

At this difficulty, **Brave** is valuable — panic reduces damage by up to 30%. Less panic = more dead zombies.

Strategy Guide — Wave 1

You've survived your first week. You know how to push, swing a crowbar, and find a can of beans. Now stop surviving and start thriving. This covers intermediate strategy, base building, crafting, and mid-game planning.

Assumes completion of Wave 0.

1. Base Building & Fortification

A closed-curtain house was fine for Wave 0. Now you need a proper fortress.

Choosing a Base

Good bases have:

- **Multiple floors.** Stairs are natural choke points.
- **Few ground-floor windows.** Fewer entry points to defend.
- **Proximity to water.** River, lake, or well. Critical after shutoff.
- **Proximity to woods.** Foraging and trapping require forest tiles.
- **Pre-built fences or walls.** Indestructible barriers are priceless.

TIP:

Gated communities in Rosewood and Riverside have tall fences zombies can't destroy. The Riverside warehouse and Rosewood fire station are classic base locations with roof access.

Carpentry Milestones

Level 2	Board up windows.
Level 3	Build walls, door frames, rain collectors.
Level 4	Advanced rain collector barrels, bookcases.
Level 5	Stairs, large crates.
Level 6-7	Log walls, plastered walls, composters.

Key Base Features

- **Sheet rope escape:** Nail + sheet rope on a second-floor window. Climb down. Remove rope from inside.
- **Airlock:** Small room with two doors at entrance. Outer door breaks, you have a second barrier.
- **Generator placement:** On the roof or sealed shed. It's noisy and attracts zombies — keep it away from sleeping area.

2. Farming

Long-term food. Once water and power shut off, farms become essential.

Getting Started

- Find seeds (farming stores, warehouses, kitchens).
- Find trowel or shovel.
- Dig furrows, sow seeds, water each plant.
- Check daily for growth, water level, and disease.

Crop Selection

Cabbages	Fastest (10 days). Rots quickly. Good for practice.
Potatoes	Slow (26 days). Long shelf life. Best staple.
Tomatoes	Medium (18 days).
Carrots	Medium (18 days). Good nutrition.

TIP:

Stagger planting. Don't plant everything on the same day or everything rots at once. Plant a few seeds every 3-4 days.

Disease

Check plants daily. Remove any diseased plant immediately (it spreads). Don't overwater. Leave gaps between different crops.

3. Trapping & Fishing

Trapping

- Craft traps (twine + wire + plank) and bait with food.
- Place in forest tiles, 75+ tiles from any player structure.
- Leave the area for at least 1 hour. Trapping doesn't work near players.
- Check within 24 hours — dead animals rot.

Fishing

- Craft or find a fishing rod (sturdy stick + fishing line + hook).
- Stand next to river/lake/pond. Right-click > Fish.
- Dawn and dusk yield the most fish (6:00-9:00 and 18:00-21:00).
- Winter fishing is much harder. At Fishing 2, you can spear fish without a rod.

4. Vehicles & Mechanics

Finding and Starting a Car

- Cars spawn in driveways, parking lots, roads.
- Check the glove box for a key. Also check the ground and nearby zombies.
- Check the gas gauge — many cars are empty. Bring a gas can.
- To hotwire without a key: need Mechanics 2 + Electrical 1. Right-click > Hotwire.

Vehicle Condition

Engine	Below 30% may not start.
Battery	Drains over time. Charge with battery charger.
Gas Tank	Fill from gas cans or fuel pumps.
Tires	Burst tires prevent driving.

Muffler

Broken muffler = extremely noisy car.

WARNING:

Cars attract zombies. Don't drive directly to your base. Park a short distance away and walk.

Leveling Mechanics

Read Mechanics skill book. Remove and reinstall parts (lightbulbs, radio, battery) for XP. Repeat. Higher Mechanics allows engine/brake/suspension repairs.

5. Generators & Electrical

After the power grid fails, generators are your only electricity.

- Find a generator in sheds, garages, warehouses.
- Find “**How to Use Generators**” magazine in bookstores, schools, mailboxes. You cannot connect a generator without it.
- Place generator **outside** — indoor generators produce carbon monoxide. You will die in your sleep.
- Connect: right-click generator > Connect. Turn on.
- A full tank lasts about 4-5 days.

DANGER:

Generator indoors = death. Always outdoors or on the roof.

Level Electrical by dismantling TVs, radios, digital watches, lamps. At Electrical 1, you can hotwire cars (with Mechanics 2).

6. Metalworking

For stronger structures and vehicle repair.

- Find a propane torch and welding mask (warehouses, garages).
- Find metal sheets, bars, pipes (disassemble metal furniture, wrecked cars).
- Build metal walls, doors, crates — stronger than wood.
- Repair vehicle bodywork with metal sheets.

TIP:

Propane torches are finite. Use wood for basic structures, save metal for critical fortifications like your front door.

7. Medical System

Injury Types

Scratch

7% zombie infection. Bandage.

Laceration	25% infection. Bandage, change when dirty.
Deep Wound	Suture with needle + thread. Then bandage.
Bite	100% fatal. No treatment. Prepare to die.
Fracture	Splint (branch + ripped sheet). Weeks to heal.

Supplies to Carry

Bandages (5+), disinfectant, painkillers, beta blockers (for panic), tweezers (for glass/bullets).

DANGER:

Zombie infection and wound infection are different. Wound infection = curable (antibiotics).
Zombie infection = fatal (queasy -> fever -> dead). You'll know which one within 12 hours.

8. Tailoring & Armor

Add protective patches to clothing.

- Find needle + thread (sewing kits, houses, clothing stores).
- Rip clothing for leather/denim/cloth strips.
- Right-click clothing > Inspect > Add Patch.
- Leather patches give the most protection.
- Prioritize hands and forearms — most common injury locations.

TIP:

Leather jackets and firefighter gear have high base protection. Patch them with leather for maximum defense. A fully patched leather jacket stops most scratches.

9. Long-Term Survival Planning

Pre-Shutoff Checklist

- Find 2+ generators and the generator magazine.
- Stockpile 10+ gas cans. Gas pumps need power — fill up before it's out.
- Build 4+ rain collector barrels (Carpentry 4).
- Fill every pot, bucket, bottle with water.
- Start a farm. Cabbages for quick food, potatoes for storage.

Winter Survival

- Stockpile warm clothes — sweaters, jackets, scarves, gloves.
- Antique oven for indoor heat (rare, found in warehouses/cabins). Campfire indoors = death.
- Farming stops in winter. Build indoor farm with heat source if needed.
- Fishing and foraging yields drop significantly. Trapping continues at reduced rates.
- Your stockpile matters now. Every can you saved is a meal.

The Long Game

After 2-3 months: fortified base, food independence, working vehicles, high skills. The challenge becomes venturing further (Louisville, military checkpoints), building outposts, and maxing skills. When you reach this stage and want more, you're ready for Wave 2.

Modlist – Wave 1

Wave 1 introduces visual upgrades, additional content, vehicles, and mild gameplay expansions. All mods verified B42 compatible as of July 2026.

Mod Manager

[B42] Mod Manager

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: UI / QoL

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds a dedicated mod management interface with profiles, drag-and-drop load order, and conflict detection.

Mandatory for all waves. Create a 'Wave 1' profile.

Framework

that DAMN Library (Continued)

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: Framework

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Core library required by KI5 vehicle mods. B42-compatible continuation of the original that DAMN Library.

Required by KI5 vehicle mods. Load after Mod Manager, before vehicles.

Items & Equipment

US Military Grenades [B42]

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: Items / Weapons

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds 6 hand-crafted military grenade types: fragmentation, incendiary, stun (flashbang), and grenade bandolier. Models made in Blender from photo references.

Adds military-grade explosives with hand-crafted models. No reused assets.

[B42+ MP] Black Powder Gunsmithing

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: Items / Weapons

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Black powder-era firearms and gunsmithing system. Craft and maintain muzzle-loading weapons.

Historical firearms with unique crafting mechanics. Fits Wave 1's mild gameplay expansion.

[B42] The Long Dark Guns

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: Items / Weapons

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds iconic firearms from The Long Dark into Project Zomboid B42. Small, curated weapon pack.

A few additional firearms that match the gritty survival aesthetic.

Skullys Lowerback Dufflebags, Chest Rigs + Fannypack, Container Rebalance [42.16 +]

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: Items / QoL

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Equip duffel bags on the lower back alongside backpacks. Chest rigs no longer conflict with fanny packs. Rebalanced container capacity.

More flexible inventory management. All features optional via mod settings.

More Books [B42.19]

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: Items / Literature

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds additional skill books and reading material to the world. Expands the literature available for skill progression.

More variety in skill books and reading material.

MRE Mod

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: Items / Food

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds MRE (Meal, Ready-to-Eat) food items found in military and survival locations.

Expands military-adjacent food loot without overhauling cooking systems.

UI & Quality of Life

Extra Map Symbols[B42]

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: UI / QoL

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds dozens of extra annotation symbols for the in-game map. Better than vanilla B42 symbols.

More map symbols for marking loot stashes, dangerous areas, and points of interest.

Better Lockpicking (Continued) B42.19+

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: UI / QoL

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Improved lockpicking interface with visual feedback and progress indication. Continued fork for B42.19+.

Makes the lockpicking minigame clearer and more responsive.

Highlight It! B42 [MP]

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: UI / QoL

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Highlights found items, containers, and interactive objects for easier visibility. Supports MP.

Reduces eye strain by making lootable objects more visible.

[B42.19][MP] Known And Collected

Steam Workshop

Category: UI / QoL

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Tracks which recipes you know and which items you've collected. Adds collection progress UI.

Helps you keep track of what you've found and what you still need.

Wishlist Loot [B42.19]

Steam Workshop

Category: UI / QoL

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Create a wishlist of desired loot items. Get notified when you find items on your list.

Never accidentally skip a critical crafting component again.

[B41,B42] Show VHS skills in tooltip

Steam Workshop

Category: UI / QoL

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Shows which skills a VHS tape grants directly in the item tooltip. Works in B41 and B42.

Saves you from memorizing which VHS tapes teach which skills.

Item Arrange

Steam Workshop

Category: UI / QoL

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds inventory organization tools. Arrange items by category, name, or condition.

Better inventory sorting without the overhead of a full sorting overhaul.

Minidoracat MiniMap Zones for B42

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: UI / QoL

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds zone labels and boundaries to the minimap. Helps with navigation and region identification.

Useful for orienting yourself in unfamiliar parts of the map.

Graphics

Authentic Z + CDDA Specials – 42.19 Patch (SP & MP)

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: Graphics / Models

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Gives zombie types unique visual appearances: Red Hazmat (Master Z), Athletic wear (Feral Z), Mime (Screecher), Charcoal skin (Brute), Biker (Tough), Football (Wrestler). SP drops worn outfits.

Makes special zombie types visually identifiable at a glance. No gameplay changes.

Bleeding Zombies [B41/B42]

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: Graphics

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Zombies bleed visually when struck. Blood pools form on the ground during combat.

Adds visual feedback to combat. Compatible with both B41 and B42.

Rainbow Blood!!

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: Graphics / Textures

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Replaces default blood textures with more vivid, colorful variants. Multiple blood color options.

Makes blood effects more visible and satisfying. Purely cosmetic.

More Lore Documents

Steam Workshop

Category: Graphics / Content

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds new lore documents, notes, and visual collectibles scattered throughout the world.

Expands the storytelling elements of the game with new readable items.

Vehicles

'70 Chevrolet Chevelle / El Camino

Steam Workshop

Category: Vehicles

Dependencies: that DAMN Library (Continued)

System Impact: Adds the classic 1970 Chevrolet Chevelle and El Camino variants. KI5 quality vehicle mod with detailed textures and physics.

Classic American muscle. Requires that DAMN Library (Continued).

'69 Ford Mustang

Steam Workshop

Category: Vehicles

Dependencies: that DAMN Library (Continued)

System Impact: Adds the 1969 Ford Mustang with multiple variants (302, 429, Mach 1). B41 and B42 compatible.

Legendary muscle car. Multiple engine variants to find and restore.

[B42] Nissan Skyline GTR R34 - Fixed & Multiplayer

Steam Workshop

Category: Vehicles

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds the Nissan Skyline GTR R34 sports car. Fixed for B42 and includes multiplayer support.

Import sports car for those who want something different from American muscle.

1967 Chevrolet Impala - Rust edition

Steam Workshop

Category: Vehicles

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds the 1967 Chevrolet Impala with rusted, weathered textures. Fits the post-apocalyptic aesthetic.

Beat-up classic sedan that looks right at home in the apocalypse.

Flip Vehicle [B42]

Steam Workshop

Category: Vehicles / QoL

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Allows flipping overturned vehicles back onto their wheels. Essential QoL for vehicle-heavy gameplay.

No more abandoning a perfectly good car just because it rolled over.

Professions & Traits

More Description For Traits [B42.19 FIX]

Steam Workshop

Category: Professions / Traits

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Replaces vague trait descriptions with detailed, numeric values. Know exactly what each trait does before choosing.

Essential for making informed character creation decisions.

Ted's Expanded Professions

Steam Workshop

Category: Professions

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds new occupations and profession options for character creation. Expands roleplaying possibilities.

More character backgrounds for roleplaying variety.

Survivor Quirks

Steam Workshop

Category: Traits

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds new positive and negative quirks for character creation. Mild trait expansion that doesn't overhaul the system.

A few extra personality traits for character variety.

[B42] Immersive Blind Trait

Steam Workshop

Category: Traits

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds a blind trait with immersive gameplay mechanics. Play as a blind survivor with unique challenges.

For experienced players looking for a radically different challenge.

Content & Locations

New Tent Features (B42.19)

Steam Workshop

Category: Content / Building

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Expands tent crafting and functionality. Build campfires near tents, new tent variants, improved camping mechanics.

Makes wilderness survival more viable with better camping options.

Knox County Archives 1.0

Steam Workshop

Category: Content / Map

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds a new explorable location: the Knox County Archives building. Contains unique loot and lore.

New point of interest to discover during your exploration.

Better Sorting – Status Update

INFO:

Better Sorting remains unavailable for B42. The situation is unchanged since Wave 0:

- Original Better Sorting (2313387159): B41 only, last updated 2023.
- [ABANDONED][B42] fork (3413005308): Marked abandoned by its author.
- Compatibility patch (3624020087): Support suspended by author as of January 2026. Depends on the abandoned fork.
- A new sorting mod is in development but not yet released.

For inventory organization, Wave 1 uses Item Arrange as a lightweight alternative. A full B42-native sorting solution will be revisited in Wave 2 if one emerges.

Load Order

NOTE:

Recommended load order for Wave 1:

1. [B42] Mod Manager
2. that DAMN Library (Continued)
3. Professions & Traits
4. Content & Locations
5. Items & Equipment
6. Vehicles
7. Graphics
8. UI & Quality of Life

TIP:

Total mods in Wave 1: 30 (including Mod Manager and framework). Combined with Wave 0's 4 mods, total is 34. Create a "Wave 1" profile in Mod Manager and enable all Wave 1 mods on top of the Wave 0 base.

Wave 2

No One is Coming

The radio went silent three months ago. The last transmission you heard was a military frequency broadcasting evacuation coordinates for a city that was already burning. You've been on the move ever since — through towns, through forests, through hell. You've buried everyone who trusted you. You've put down people who turned before your eyes. You don't make friends anymore. You don't make plans. You don't hope. Because hope is a lie that gets you killed. There is no cavalry coming over the hill. There is no cure being airlifted from a secret lab. There is no extraction team. No one is coming. There is only you, your skills, your scars, and the dead. And you intend to outlast every last one of them.

Begin Wave 2

Background — No One is Coming

The radio went silent three months ago. You were holed up in a fire station near Brandenburg when the last transmission crackled through — a military frequency, staticky and desperate, broadcasting evacuation coordinates for a city that was already burning. You listened until the static swallowed the voice and the radio went dead.

That was the last time anyone promised you rescue.

You've been on the move ever since. Through towns where the streets are carpeted with the dead. Through forests where the silence is worse than the screaming. You've buried everyone who trusted you — faces and names you won't let yourself remember because remembering makes you slow and being slow makes you dead.

You don't make friends anymore. You don't make plans longer than the next sunrise. You don't hope. Hope is a lie that gets you killed. Hope is what killed Daniels when he went back for the photo of his wife. Hope is what killed Chen when she insisted there had to be a cure.

There is no cavalry coming over the hill. There is no cure. There is no extraction team. No one is coming.

There is only you. Your skills. Your scars. Your refusal to die. And the dead — thousands, millions, an entire world of them — who will never stop, never sleep, never give up trying to end you.

You intend to outlast every last one of them.

Sandbox Settings — Wave 2

No Hope configuration. The ultimate challenge. Everything is against you.

Game World

Start from **Apocalypse** preset, apply all overrides. This is custom hardcore.

Population

Zombie Count	High (2.0x)
Distribution	Uniform
Peak Multiplier	3.0
Peak Day	14
Respawn	0.1x (nearly off — cleared stays cleared)

Zombie Lore

Speed	Random (shamblers + sprinters mixed)
Strength	Tough
Toughness	Tough
Transmission	Blood + Saliva (scratches + lacerations + bites)
Cognition	Navigate + Open Doors
Memory	Long
Sight	Eagle
Hearing	Pinpoint
Environmental Attacks	On
Drag Down	On

Loot

All Categories	Extremely Rare
----------------	----------------

Character

XP Multiplier	0.75x
Multihit	Disabled
Rear Vulnerability	High
Starter Kit	Disabled

Clothing Degradation	Fast
-----------------------------	------

World

Water Shutoff	0 days (instant)
Electricity Shutoff	0 days (instant)
House Alarms	Frequent
Locked Houses	Frequent
Helicopter	Often
Meta Events	Often
Sleeping Event	Sometimes
Car Spawn Rate	Low
Initial Gas	Very Low

Nature

All Abundances	Very Poor
Compost Time	Slow (2 weeks)

Starting Conditions

Starting Month	December
Temperature	Cold

Starting Location

West Point or **Muldraugh**. No easy option. West Point has the highest zombie density outside Louisville.

Hardcore Trait Build

Occupation: Fire Officer (+1 Axe, +1 Sprinting, +1 Strength, +1 Fitness)

Positives: Keen Hearing (6), Brave (4), Thick Skinned (6), Outdoorsman (2), Wakeful (2)

Negatives: Thin-Skinned (+8), Slow Healer (+6), Weak Stomach (+3), High Thirst (+6)

DANGER:

Water is off. Power is out. It's December. Every scratch can infect you. Zombies open doors. You will die on day one. Multiple times. This is intentional.

Expert Guide — Wave 2

This is not a tutorial. You've conquered Wave 0 and Wave 1. Now face the real apocalypse. Wave 2 settings alone will kill most players. The mods add entire new survival systems. Die. Learn. Repeat.

Prerequisites: Wave 0 and Wave 1 completed.

1. The Winter Start

December. No water. No power. It's cold. Here's what that means:

Day 1 Priorities (in this order)

- **Warm clothing:** Jacket, sweater, hat, scarf, gloves. Layer everything. Check every bedroom, every corpse.
- **Water:** Every sink is dry. Find bottled water or reach a river/lake immediately.
- **Weapon:** Anything. You can't push-stomp at 2.0x density.
- **Heat source:** Fireplace, antique oven, or generator + oven. You can't survive winter without a way to warm up.
- **Canned food:** All fresh food has rotted. Every can is precious.

DANGER:

Hypothermia kills faster than starvation. Cold and wet = dead within hours. Heat + dry clothes before anything else.

2. Sprinters

In Wave 2, zombies are fast. Some **sprint**.

Rules

- **Sprinters are faster than you.** Never fight one in the open. Back to a wall.
- **Windows and fences are weapons.** Sprinters lunge through and fall. Stomp them while down.
- **Push then stomp.** Even sprinters can be pushed (Space). Push, stomp, repeat.
- **Guns for emergencies.** A shotgun blast clears a charging sprinter — but the noise brings more.
- **Vehicles are death traps.** Sprinters surround your car while you start it. Clear the area first.
- **Sneak everywhere.** Walk. Crouch near buildings. Sprinters hear footsteps from far away.
- **Keen Hearing is nearly mandatory.** Sprinter from behind = dead before you react.

Identifying Sprinters

Sprinters look gaunt and move with purpose. If a zombie moves faster than a brisk walk toward you, it's a sprinter. Kill it first — every time.

3. Hardcore Survival Systems

Wave 2 mods add new survival mechanics. Specific mod names and details are in the Modlist chapter. This section covers **how to approach** these systems.

Nutrition Management

Track calories, protein, carbs, fats. You need 2000 cal/day; combat burns more. Protein from meat maintains strength. Fats from fish/processed food — zero fat causes health problems. Diversify: don't eat the same crop every day. Trapping and fishing become **essential**, not optional.

Temperature & Hypothermia

Expanded temperature tracks body heat, wind chill, wetness, clothing insulation. Wool > cotton. Wet clothes lose insulation — change immediately after getting wet. Forest blocks wind; open fields don't. Hypothermia stages: shivering -> confusion -> unconscious -> dead.

Hygiene

Wash regularly (soap + water source). Body odor may attract zombies (mod-dependent). Dirty bandages are more dangerous — change frequently. Wash blood off clothes — bloody clothes increase panic and infection risk.

Mental Health

Killing zombies has psychological cost. You desensitize over time. Extended isolation causes depression — read books, listen to music, engage in hobbies. Traumatic events (comrade death, base loss) cause lasting debuffs. Some mods add addiction systems — don't run out of cigarettes.

Thirst

Expanded thirst = need more water. Carry 3 full bottles minimum. Rain collectors are survival-critical — build many. Boil river/lake water before drinking. Water purification tablets (if mods add them) are gold.

4. Advanced Combat

Horde Clearing Methods

The Funnel: Lure zombies to a narrow choke point (alley, door). Kill one at a time. Retreat when tired, return.

The Fire Method: Build a campfire in an open parking lot (NOT near buildings). Lead horde through fire. Zombies burn.

DANGER

Fire spreads to buildings and trees. Town-leveling destruction possible. Parking lots and highways only.

The Noise Distraction: Set off a car alarm or use noise makers (Electrical skill) far from your target. Zombies migrate. Loot the now-empty area. Be gone before they wander back.

Vehicle Reversing: Drive in reverse through hordes. Trunk takes damage, not engine. Use a beater car you don't care about.

5. Community Server Setup

Self-Hosted

Main menu > Host > Create Server. Configure sandbox settings, add mods. Friends join via your Steam name or IP.

Dedicated Server

Install **Project Zomboid Dedicated Server** (Steam > Tools). Configure `servertest.ini` with sandbox and mod Workshop IDs. Port forward 16261-16262 UDP, 8766 UDP. Run `StartServer64.bat`.

INFO:

Admin commands: /adduser, /grantadmin. Full list at pzwiki.net/wiki/Dedicated_Server.

6. Endgame Meta

After 2+ months in Wave 2, you've beaten the hardest configuration.

Sustainability Checklist

- 8+ rain collectors, plumbed to sinks (pipe wrench).
- Year-round indoor farm with heat + light.
- Trapping field + fishing spot.
- 2+ generators, rotation schedule, 20+ gas cans.
- Metal walls, airlock, escape route.
- Antique oven + log stockpile.
- Medical stockpile.

Infinite Resources

Wood (trees), water (rain), food (farming/trapping/fishing), stone (foraging) = infinite. Finite: gasoline, ammunition, medical supplies, skill books. Use finite resources sparingly.

Your Goal

There is no win condition. Set your own: clear Louisville, max every skill, survive a full year, build the ultimate base. **No one is coming. This is how you lived.**

Modlist – Wave 2

Wave 2 is the full apocalypse. Over 40 mods across every category – realism, difficulty, content, immersion. Each adds a layer to the survival simulation. The training wheels are off. No one is coming.

Mod Manager

[B42] Mod Manager

Steam Workshop

Category: UI / QoL

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Mod management, profiles, load order, conflict detection.

Mandatory. Create a 'Wave 2' profile. Disable all Wave 0 and Wave 1 mods. Wave 2 is a fresh start.

Frameworks & Libraries

Profession Framework B42

Steam Workshop

Category: Framework

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Framework for adding and editing professions and traits. Simplifies modding, allows professions to have special traits (Brave, Lucky, etc.), and simplifies starting gear assignment. Required by profession-adding mods.

Required by all profession/trait mods in this wave. Load early.

Mark Dynamic Traits Framework (MDTF)

Steam Workshop

Category: Framework

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Marks dynamic traits with [~] in the UI so you know which traits can be earned or lost mid-game. Supports dynamic trait mods like Evolving Traits World.

Lightweight compatibility layer. Required by dynamic trait systems.

Skill Recovery Journal PATCH EDITION (42.19)

Steam Workshop

Category: Framework

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds craftable skill journals that preserve skill progress across death. Write down what you know, and your next survivor can recover those skills. Essential for hardcore runs.

Critical for Wave 2. Death will come. Your skills don't have to die with you.

Distillery & Biofuel Framework

Steam Workshop

Category: Framework

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Framework for brewing alcohol and producing biofuel. Enables distilling systems and alternative fuel production. Required by brewing/biofuel mods.

Enables alternative fuel and brewing systems. Load before crafting mods.

Survival Overhauls

RECIPES OF DEATH B42 HARDCORE

Steam Workshop

Category: Survival / Hardcore

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Hardcore survival recipe overhaul. Deadlier crafting, more realistic material requirements, and recipes that punish mistakes. Not for the faint of heart.

Makes crafting more dangerous and demanding. The name is a warning.

Lifestyle: Hobbies 42.12 version

Steam Workshop

Category: Survival / Lifestyle

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds a lifestyle and hobby system. Smoking, drinking, recreational activities -- manage your survivor's morale and vices alongside hunger and thirst. Vices have consequences.

Adds depth to the daily survival loop. Morale matters now.

Realistic Temperature [B42]

Steam Workshop

Category: Survival / Realism

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Overhauls the body temperature system with realistic heat and cold mechanics. Clothing insulation matters. Hypothermia and heat stroke are real threats. Weather kills.

No more ignoring the seasons. Dress for the weather or die.

Knox Weather Receiver [B42] [SP/MP]

Steam Workshop

Category: Survival / Weather

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds a weather receiver item that forecasts upcoming weather, temperature, and storm systems. Plan your supply runs around the forecast -- or get caught in a blizzard.

Knowledge is survival. Check the forecast before you leave base.

Death Burden | Realistic death

Steam Workshop

Category: Survival / Hardcore

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Realistic death consequences. Corpses have weight and burden, creating both practical and psychological challenges. Cleaning up after a fight has real cost.

Every kill has a consequence. You can't just walk away from a massacre.

[B42] Take A Bath And Shower

Steam Workshop

Category: Survival / Hygiene

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds hygiene mechanics -- bathe in tubs, shower when water works, wash in rivers. Uncleanliness affects mood, infection risk, and NPC interactions.

The apocalypse doesn't mean you stop being human. Stay clean or suffer.

Plumbed Sink Mains Water Fix [B42]

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: Survival / QoL

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Fixes plumbed sinks to properly draw from mains water supply while it lasts. Essential plumbing fix for base building and water management.

Make your base plumbing actually work. Water won't last forever.

Zombie Overhauls

Hark's Horde Night Revamped [B42.19]

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: Zombies / Horde

Dependencies: None

System Impact: On a recurring schedule you set, the dead come for your base. Rebuilt for B42 with MP support, smarter spawning, customizable sprinter percentages, and A.E.B.S. integration. They know where you live.

The centerpiece of Wave 2 zombie difficulty. Configure carefully.

Spring Cleaning – Horde Filter [B42 / MP]

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: Zombies / Management

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Filters and manages zombie horde spawns. Control what types of zombies appear, adjust spawn rates, and keep your game performant by limiting corpse accumulation.

Performance tool and difficulty tuner. Essential with large hordes.

IT'S THRILLER TIME! [horde]

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: Zombies / Horde

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Special themed zombie horde events with synchronized swarming behavior. Adds variety and unpredictability to the undead threat.

Adds chaos to the horde experience. Not all swarms are created equal.

Raining Zombies

Steam Workshop

Category: Zombies / Chaos

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Zombies literally fall from the sky during certain weather events. Chaotic, terrifying, and deeply unfair -- perfect for a world with no hope of rescue.

Pure chaos mod. The sky itself is no longer safe.

Wake Them Up -- B42.19

Steam Workshop

Category: Zombies / Behavior

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Changes zombie wake-up behavior. Sleeping zombies are more sensitive to noise, light, and movement. Stealth becomes a genuine survival skill, not just a convenience.

Stealth is no longer optional. Wake up the wrong room and you die.

Realism Systems

Firearms B42 - Suppressors and Magazines Fix

Steam Workshop

Category: Realism / Firearms

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Fixes suppressors and magazine mechanics for B42 firearms. Proper attachment behavior, realistic magazine loading, and suppressor degradation over use.

Makes firearms behave like firearms. Suppressors aren't magic.

Shoot Through Barricades

Steam Workshop

Category: Realism / Ballistics

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Bullets can penetrate barricaded windows, thin walls, and doors. No more invincible wooden planks. Adds realistic ballistics penetration to the game.

Wood planks aren't bulletproof. Neither are your barricades against you.

Water Pipes (Continued) B42.19+

Steam Workshop

Category: Realism / Plumbing

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Plumbing system for bases. Connect rain barrels to sinks, showers, and washing machines. Continued fork maintained for B42.19+. Requires tools and skill to set up.

Core base-building infrastructure. Running water is a luxury you earn.

PlumbingPlus B42 – Easy Generator Fueling

Steam Workshop

Category: Realism / Electricity

Dependencies: Water Pipes (Continued) B42.19+

System Impact: Add-on for Water Pipes. Simplifies generator fueling by connecting fuel barrels directly to generators. Keep the lights on without constant refueling trips.

Requires Water Pipes. Automates generator maintenance for large bases.

Burnt Ground Recultivation [B42]

Steam Workshop

Category: Realism / Farming

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Allows recultivation of burnt or degraded soil. Essential for long-term farming sustainability after fires, soil exhaustion, or zombie decay contamination.

Long-term survival requires sustainable farming. Reclaim dead earth.

Professions & Traits

[B42] NEW PROFESSIONS AND TRAITS

Steam Workshop

Category: Professions & Traits

Dependencies: Profession Framework B42

System Impact: Adds new occupations and traits for character creation. Expanded roleplaying possibilities for the hardened survivor -- military, first responder, and survivalist backgrounds.

Requires Profession Framework B42. More ways to define your survivor.

Seinar's Extended Professions

Steam Workshop

Category: Professions & Traits

Dependencies: Profession Framework B42

System Impact: Extended profession pack with unique occupations, starting gear, and trait combinations. More career backgrounds for the apocalypse veteran.

Requires Profession Framework B42. Even more occupation variety.

QP Survivor Contracts B42 + B41

Steam Workshop

Category: Professions & Traits

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds survivor contract traits -- occupations tied to specific factions or groups. Background-driven character creation with unique starting scenarios and obligations.

Faction-aligned starts. Your past comes with strings attached.

Custom Start

Steam Workshop

Category: Professions & Traits

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Customizable starting scenarios. Choose your starting location, gear, season, and conditions. Create truly personalized hardcore starts for Wave 2.

Build your own nightmare. Start with nothing, or everything -- your call.

Crafting Expansions

Practice Crafting Skills

Steam Workshop

Category: Crafting / Training

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Practice crafting recipes using raw materials to gain XP without wasting rare components. Train your skills safely at base before attempting critical crafts.

Train without burning precious resources. Smart survivors practice first.

Workshop Vehicle Restoration [B42.19]

Steam Workshop

Category: Crafting / Vehicles

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Restore and repair vehicles at workshops. Full vehicle restoration system -- strip parts, rebuild engines, bring wrecks back to life. Requires tools, parts, and skill.

Turn scrap into transport. Every wreck is a project.

Linterna B42 (Electric & Gas Lantern)

Steam Workshop

Category: Crafting / Tools

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Craftable electric and gas lanterns. Portable light sources that don't depend on batteries alone. Essential for dark nights and extended exploration.

Light is life. Don't depend on flashlight batteries.

Industrial Propane Canister

Steam Workshop

Category: Crafting / Resources

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds larger industrial propane canisters for extended welding, cooking, and metalworking projects. More fuel, less frequent refills for serious crafters.

Industrial-scale crafting requires industrial-scale resources.

Rain Barrel Pour All

Steam Workshop

Category: Crafting / QoL

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Pour water from any container into rain barrels directly. Simplifies water collection and base water management without removing the survival challenge.

Saves clicks, not challenge. Water management is still deadly serious.

Maps & Locations

WARNING:

B42 map mods are extremely scarce. The map format changed significantly in Build 42, and most classic map mods (Raven Creek, Eerie Country, etc.) have not been updated. The mods below add location content without requiring full map overhauls. Check compatibility before adding any additional maps.

Lemon's Immersive Louisville Bridge Detonation

Steam Workshop

Category: Map / Event

Dependencies: None

System Impact: The Louisville checkpoint bridge is rigged to blow. A countdown event that permanently changes the map. Cross before it's too late, or find another way -- if one exists.

Permanently alters the game world. Time-limited. No second chances.

Blackout Predators

Steam Workshop

Category: Map / Wildlife

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds dangerous predator animals to the Kentucky wilderness. Wolves, bears, and other threats that make the forests as deadly as the towns. Nature is not your friend.

The woods aren't safe anymore. Zombies aren't the only thing hunting you.

UH-1B Helicopter [B42.19 Fix]

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: Map / Vehicles

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds a flyable UH-1B Huey helicopter. End-game vehicle requiring massive investment in parts, fuel, and skill. Not easy to obtain or maintain. Changes how you traverse the map.

The ultimate map traversal tool -- if you can earn it. Massive investment required.

Federal Ranger's [Chimera]

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: Map / Vehicles

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds a heavy armored military truck. Slow, fuel-hungry, but nearly indestructible. The ultimate survivor vehicle for crossing hostile territory.

A mobile fortress. Slow, loud, expensive to run -- and nearly unkillable.

Immersion & Atmosphere

Nuclear Protocol

[Steam Workshop](#)

Category: Immersion / Event

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Nuclear strike event system. Sirens, countdowns, and the unthinkable becomes reality. Adds existential dread to the apocalypse -- because zombies weren't bad enough.

The ultimate atmosphere mod. The world can get worse. It will.

ahz clothing b42.19 fixed

Steam Workshop

Category: Immersion / Clothing

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Expanded clothing variety for B42. More civilian and survivor outfit options. Look like you've actually been surviving for months, not shopping at the mall.

Visual variety for your hardened survivor. Form follows function.

Armor Pack B42

Steam Workshop

Category: Immersion / Protection

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds craftable and lootable armor pieces. Ballistic vests, limb protection, improvised armor. Protection has weight and movement penalties -- choose wisely.

Protection has a cost. Heavy armor slows you down. Light armor doesn't stop bites.

Spongie Clothing & Open jackets Fix B42

Steam Workshop

Category: Immersion / Clothing

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Clothing expansion with open jacket variants and layered outfit options. More visual variety for your survivor without gameplay impact.

Cosmetic clothing variety. More ways to express your survivor's identity.

Necroa – Z Com Hazmat Suits [42.19]

Steam Workshop

Category: Immersion / Gear

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds hazmat suits and protective gear inspired by zombie outbreak response teams. Full-body protection with realistic movement and visibility penalties.

Maximum protection, maximum penalty. Hazmat gear is not combat gear.

Ergonomic UI [B42]

Steam Workshop

Category: Immersion / UI

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Streamlined UI improvements for B42. Cleaner inventory, better tooltips, and more intuitive crafting menus. Quality of life without reducing difficulty.

Better interface, same brutal game. The apocalypse doesn't need a bad UI.

Checklist [B42.19]

Steam Workshop

Category: Immersion / Tracking

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Track your progress with in-game checklists. Mark off crafting milestones, loot targets, and survival goals. Stay organized when everything is falling apart.

Organize your survival. Track what matters when nothing else does.

[B42] Play Dead Weapon Mod

Steam Workshop

Category: Immersion / Weapons

Dependencies: None

System Impact: Adds unique and creative melee weapons. Improvised, brutal, and fitting for a world where everything is a potential weapon and nothing is clean.

More ways to fight. The apocalypse doesn't provide -- you improvise.

Summary

DANGER:

Wave 2's mod list is massive – over 40 mods across 8 categories. Follow the Installation chapter's load order rules carefully. Incorrect load order WILL cause crashes. The Mod Manager's conflict detection is your friend. Test your load order before committing to a long run.

TIP:

Total mods in Wave 2: 42 (including Mod Manager and 4 frameworks). Combined with Wave 1's 30 and Wave 0's 4, the full mod list is 76 mods. You are not expected to run all three waves simultaneously. Each wave is a separate profile and a separate game.

Load Order

NOTE:

Recommended load order for Wave 2:

1. [B42] Mod Manager
2. Frameworks & Libraries (Profession Framework, MDTF, Skill Recovery Journal, Distillery & Biofuel)
3. Survival Overhauls (Recipes of Death, Lifestyle, Temperature, Weather, Death Burden, Hygiene, Plumbing)
4. Zombie Overhauls (Horde Night, Horde Filter, Thriller Time, Raining Zombies, Wake Them Up)
5. Realism Systems (Firearms Fix, Shoot Through Barricades, Water Pipes, PlumbingPlus, Burnt Ground)
6. Professions & Traits (New Professions, Seinar's Extended, Survivor Contracts, Custom Start)
7. Crafting Expansions (Practice Crafting, Vehicle Restoration, Lanterns, Propane, Rain Barrel)
8. Maps & Locations (Bridge Detonation, Predators, Helicopter, Chimera)
9. Immersion & Atmosphere (Nuclear Protocol, Clothing, Armor, Hazmat, UI, Checklist, Weapons)
10. Compatibility patches (if any)